Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

UPI/Online payment fraud is a common cybercrime where attackers trick users into transferring money or revealing sensitive banking details through digital payment platforms.

A typical fraud happens in several steps. First, the attacker contacts the victim through a phone call, message, or social media, pretending to be a bank official, customer support agent, or even a buyer/seller. They create urgency by saying there is a problem with the account or a payment is pending. Next, they send a fake payment link or request the victim to scan a QR code. In some cases, they ask for OTPs or UPI PIN under the pretext of completing a transaction. Once the victim shares this information or approves the request, money is instantly transferred from their account.

This type of fraud mainly targets students, online shoppers, small business owners, and people who are not fully aware of digital payment security.

The consequences can be severe, including financial loss, unauthorized transactions, and stress for the victim. Sometimes, it becomes difficult to recover the lost money.

To stay safe, users should never share their UPI PIN or OTP, avoid scanning unknown QR codes, verify the identity of the sender, and use only trusted payment platforms.